

scripts/check-gitignore-coverage.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-05-15 (constitution-compliance plan Phase 2)
Inheritance: HelixConstitution §11.4.30 (.gitignore + No-Versioned-Build-Artifacts Mandate) + §11.4.18 (script docs)

Overview

Enforces §11.4.30: every project module / owned-by-us submodule / service / application MUST ship a proper .gitignore. Plus: NO tracked files may match the forbidden-pattern set (a tracked *.log despite the ignore-line is a violation of equal severity).

Modes

Flag	Behavior
--strict (default)	Exit 1 on any violation
--advisory	Exit 0 even on violation
LAVA_GITIGNORE_STRICT=0 env	Same as --advisory

Module-detection rules

- app, buildSrc, lava-api-go are required if present
- core/<X>/ and feature/<X>/ are required if they have build.gradle.kts (i.e., are actual Gradle modules — pure parent dirs like core/network/ are skipped)
- core/<X>/<Y>/ sub-leaf modules same rule
- All submodules/<X>/ are required (every owned-by-us submodule)

Forbidden-pattern detection

Tracked files matching ANY of these patterns trigger a violation:

- `.env`, `.env.<lc-letters>` (except `.env.example`)
- `*.pem`, `*.key`, `*.crt`
- `id_rsa*`, `id_ed25519*`
- `node_modules/`, `__pycache__/`, `.gradle/`
- `/build/`, `/dist/`, `/out/`
- `.DS_Store`, `Thumbs.db`, `*.swp`

Allowlist

The scanner has an explicit allowlist for files that match the forbidden-pattern regex but ARE legitimately tracked (e.g., deployment-recipe configs that happen to use the `.env` extension). Each allowlist entry MUST cite its rationale inline. See the `ALLOWLIST=()` array at the top of the script.

Current allowlist:

- `deployment/thinker/thinker.local.env` — deployment-recipe doc, not a secret container; rename to clearer extension owed to Phase 6 (lowercase snake_case).

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-gitignore-coverage.sh           # strict
              (default)
bash scripts/check-gitignore-coverage.sh --advisory # exit 0
              even on violation
LAVA_GITIGNORE_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-gitignore-coverage.sh # env-driven
```

Hermetic test

`tests/check-constitution/test_gitignore_coverage.sh` — 3 fixtures:

- `test_real_tree_passes` — real Lava tree exits 0
- `test_module_without_gitignore_rejected` — synthetic feature/foo/ with `build.gradle.kts` but no `.gitignore` → flagged

- `test_clean_fixture_passes` — synthetic minimal repo with `.gitignore` → passes

Cross-references

- HelixConstitution Constitution.md §11.4.30 (the mandate)
- docs/plans/2026-05-15-constitution-compliance.md Phase 2
- docs/helix-constitution-gates.md CM-GITIGNORE-PRECOMMIT-AUDIT row
- scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh (wraps this scanner per §11.4.32)